led to its replacement with opium. [72] With opium from India to China and tea from China to Europe, the Opium Wars that resulted could just as easily have been called the ‘Tea Wars’. [73] Beyond the triangular trade with China, Indian raw materials were shipped to Britain, where the industrial revolution resulted in the export of manufactured goods. The world of finance also shifted: Indian financiers played a role in Hong Kong and Shanghai, just as Baghdadi Jews sought opportunities in Bombay.

The colonial exchange of goods and capital also extended to people. Indentured labourers were taken from India, including convicts or otherwise coerced individuals, to such places as Guyana, Trinidad and Tobago, Fiji, and Mauritius where their descendants now account for over 30 per cent of the population, and about 70 per cent in the case of Mauritius. An Anglo–Dutch Treaty of 1870 led to similar indentured labour being sent from India to Suriname, where people of Indian origin still constitute over a quarter of the population. While not quite chattel slavery, such Indian labour was often transported under abysmal conditions with high death rates. [74] Indian workers were also employed elsewhere, whether on tea plantations in Ceylon or as professional workers in Burma, resulting in populations in today’s Sri Lanka and Myanmar. Beyond labour, Indians also migrated as traders to other British colonies, establishing sizeable communities in today’s Kenya, Tanzania, Uganda, South Africa, Malaysia, Singapore, and Hong Kong.

The colonial period also shaped India’s relations with the American colonies that would become the United States. After his decisive defeat at Yorktown contributed to American independence, General Charles Cornwallis was dispatched as the British commander in India, where he oversaw the war with Mysore that resulted in the defeat of Tipu Sultan. Several American-born individuals played critical roles in India, such as Elihu Yale, who became the East India Company’s chief representative in Madras. He later donated some of his substantial riches to a prestigious college in Connecticut that would later be named after him. Massachusetts-born David Ochterlony was a commander in the Anglo–Nepalese War and became Britain’s resident in the Mughal court. The United States’ third vice